

Abhishek Venkataraman

☎ 734-546-7478 | ✉ abhven@umich.edu | 🏠 abhven.com | 📷 abhven | 🌐 abhishek-venkataraman | 🇺🇸 US Citizen

Summary

Engineering leader with 15 years building and deploying robotics, autonomy, computer vision, and applied AI systems. Currently leading a 15-person perception org across CV research, data/training infra, MLOps, evaluation, and production deployment. Proven track record scaling teams, deploying autonomous vehicle fleets, driving deep-tech computer vision innovation, and translating technical strategy into business impact.

Experience

Voxel AI

San Francisco, California

DIRECTOR, PERCEPTION

Apr 2024 - Jul 2026

- Led multi-quarter technical transformation to modern VLM-based perception systems from object detection and heuristics
- Introduced eval-driven development and rebuilt data collection workflows, reducing labeling backlog from 6 months to 1 week and enabling auto-review systems that cut false positives by 80%
- Scaled deployment footprint - 10x in cameras (250 → 2,500) and 5x in customer sites (25 → 125), generating petabytes of video
- Led an org of 15 (ICs and managers) spanning CV research, training/data infra, MLOps, eval, and deployment; hired 6 Principal/Staff/Senior ICs
- Partnered with CEO to raise \$44M Series B; engaged Fortune 500 customers to drive new business and account expansion
- Owned perception strategy and multi-year roadmap with PM and TPM; stood up outcome-focused squads and set hiring and leveling guidelines across engineering
- Launched customer-facing capabilities including anonymization, data summarization, real-time SMS detection alerts, and thermal use cases

Proxy Robotics

Stanford, California

CO-FOUNDER

Mar 2025 - Aug 2026

- Built full-stack multi-robot low-latency teleoperation platform (Kinova G3, Franka Emika, Hello Robot Stretch, AgileX Piper, Lite6); supports VR (Quest 3), haptic (Force Dynamics Omega), and joystick input, plus stereo and wrist cameras. Live demo: demo.proxyrobotics.ai
- Implemented multi-robot monitoring, remote interventions, data logging, and search & retrieval; trained operators on simulated robots (MuJoCo) before customer deployments. Incorporated RBAC, admin controls, and security to make the platform real-world ready
- Demonstrated live cross-continental teleoperation between Stanford Robotics Center and Bengaluru for a customer
- Closed 4 design partners (3PL, construction, specialized manipulation) in 10 weeks, including a \$250k LOI for pilot deployment

Nuro

Mountain View, California

TECHNICAL LEAD & MANAGER, BEHAVIOR EVALUATION

Feb 2022 - Feb 2024

- Drove ML adoption in behavior planning through Behavior Core Eval, improving stack performance 36%; highlighted by CEO in investor updates
- Partnered with Heads of Behavior and Software to measure weekly behavior improvement across ODDs
- Technical Lead for Behavior Core Eval, the main eval solution used by 40+ Engineers, running entirely off-board across millions of miles of driving data; led a cross-functional team of 10 developers & designers, including 4 direct reports
- Led the behavior-evaluation workflow of a company-wide, ML-first behavior transformation, synthesizing requirements across Simulation, Perception, TPM, and Product
- Increased team throughput over 50% by identifying and automating time-consuming manual workflows using Buildkite and Retool

May Mobility

Ann Arbor, Michigan

SENIOR ROBOTICS ENGINEER, PERCEPTION

Jun 2018 - Jan 2022

- Developed end-to-end semantic classification pipeline (image acquisition, sensor fusion, temporal tracking) and optimized policy rollouts for multi-policy decision-making, achieving 3x speedup in behavior prediction
- Architecture lead for Vulnerable Road User (VRU) interaction; designed end-to-end pipeline from classification to vehicle behavior, team of 3
- Deployed a perception solution that generalized across 50+ vehicles and multiple platforms (GEM, Sienna, Lexus) and 10+ cities across the US and Japan, generating \$1M+ in ride revenue
- Product and technical lead for vehicle-camera traffic light classification; replaced a brittle roadside-infrastructure system with a mapping-based in-vehicle solution, owning the end-to-end vision architecture, data collection & labeling, and evaluation
- Mentored 10+ engineers across Autonomy and AutoOps and built the new-hire onboarding process
- Architected and deployed a scalable pipeline in AWS/Databricks to ingest petabytes of field data and calculate metrics to measure autonomy performance

Education

University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, Michigan

MASTER'S IN ROBOTICS

2016 - 2018

Indian Institute of Technology Madras

Chennai, India

B.TECH IN MECHANICAL ENGINEERING

2007 - 2012

Skills

Technical

Perception, segmentation, tracking, sensor fusion, behavior evaluation, simulation, multi-policy planning, autonomy; **Models** - YOLO, SAM3, VJEPa, ResNet, VideoMAE, Qwen, Gemma, Gemini, ACT; **Frameworks** - TensorFlow, PyTorch, OpenCV, ROS

Languages

C++, Python, Go, C, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Infrastructure

AWS, BigQuery, Databricks, Docker, Kubernetes, Ray, ClearML, Kolena, Encord, Grafana, Bazel, Buildkite, Retool